



Control Panel

A Windows System tool



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Control Panel

What does it do?

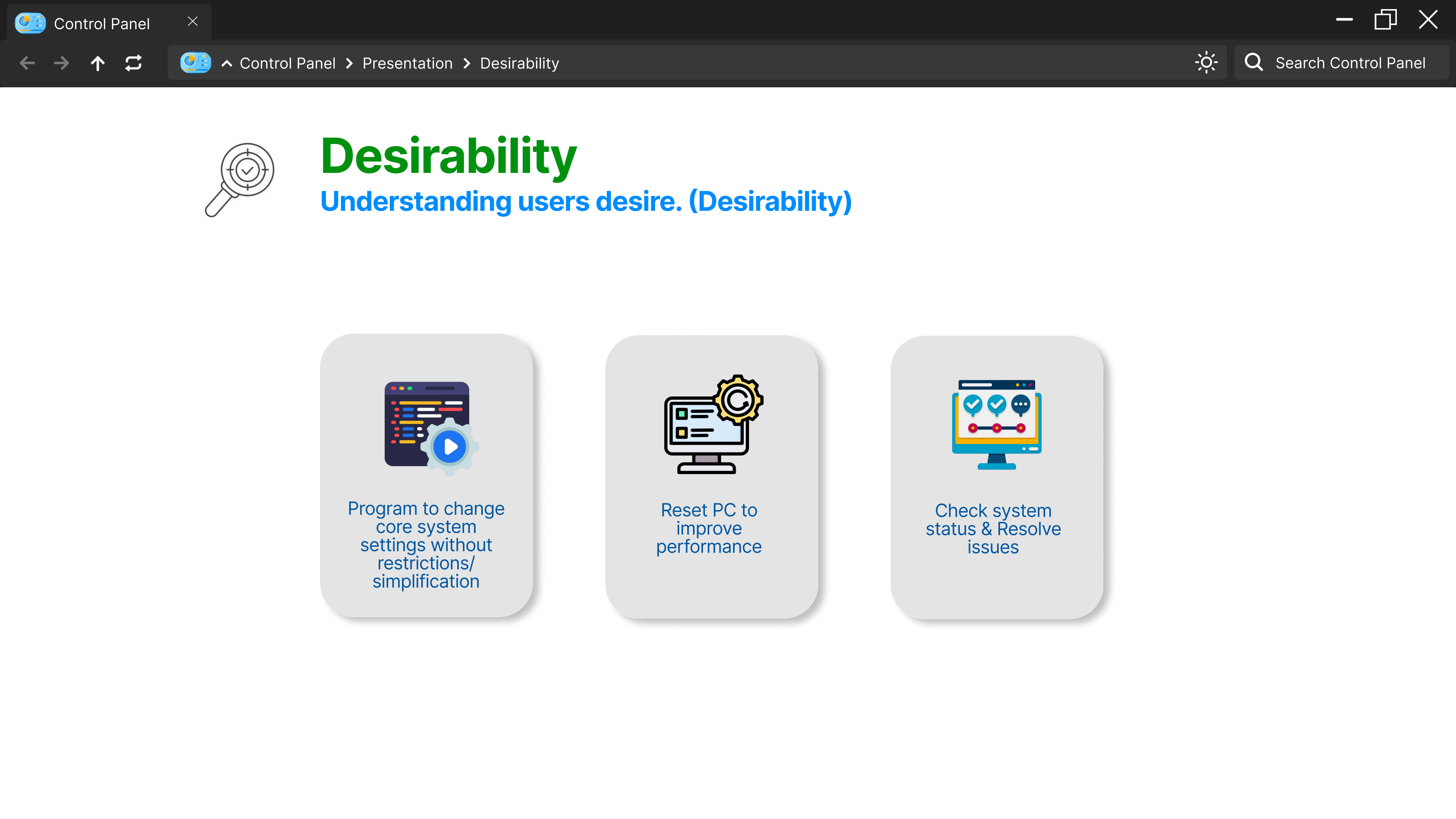
User freedom to change settings across hardware & software system wide to at any depth or complexity

Why does it need to change?

Design has remained unchanged since Windows 7 (2009), which only had a minor upgrade over the Windows 98 Release of the Control Panel. Can the interactions be improved? To explore this, we decided to redesign the Control Panel.

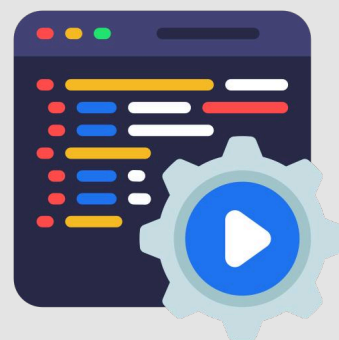
What is the Primary focus of the redesign?

Functionality is the core of this study, as User Retention is not a need of control panel. You strictly need to be there for as little time as possible, and any user should be able to navigate through multiple channels to reach where they want to.

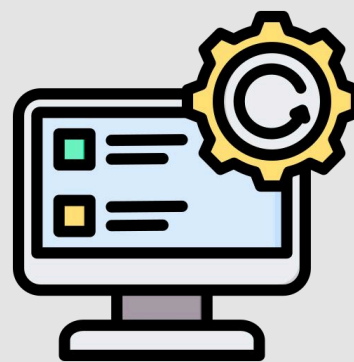


Desirability

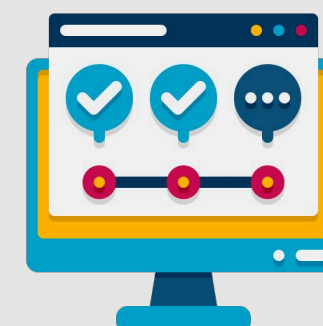
Understanding users desire. (Desirability)



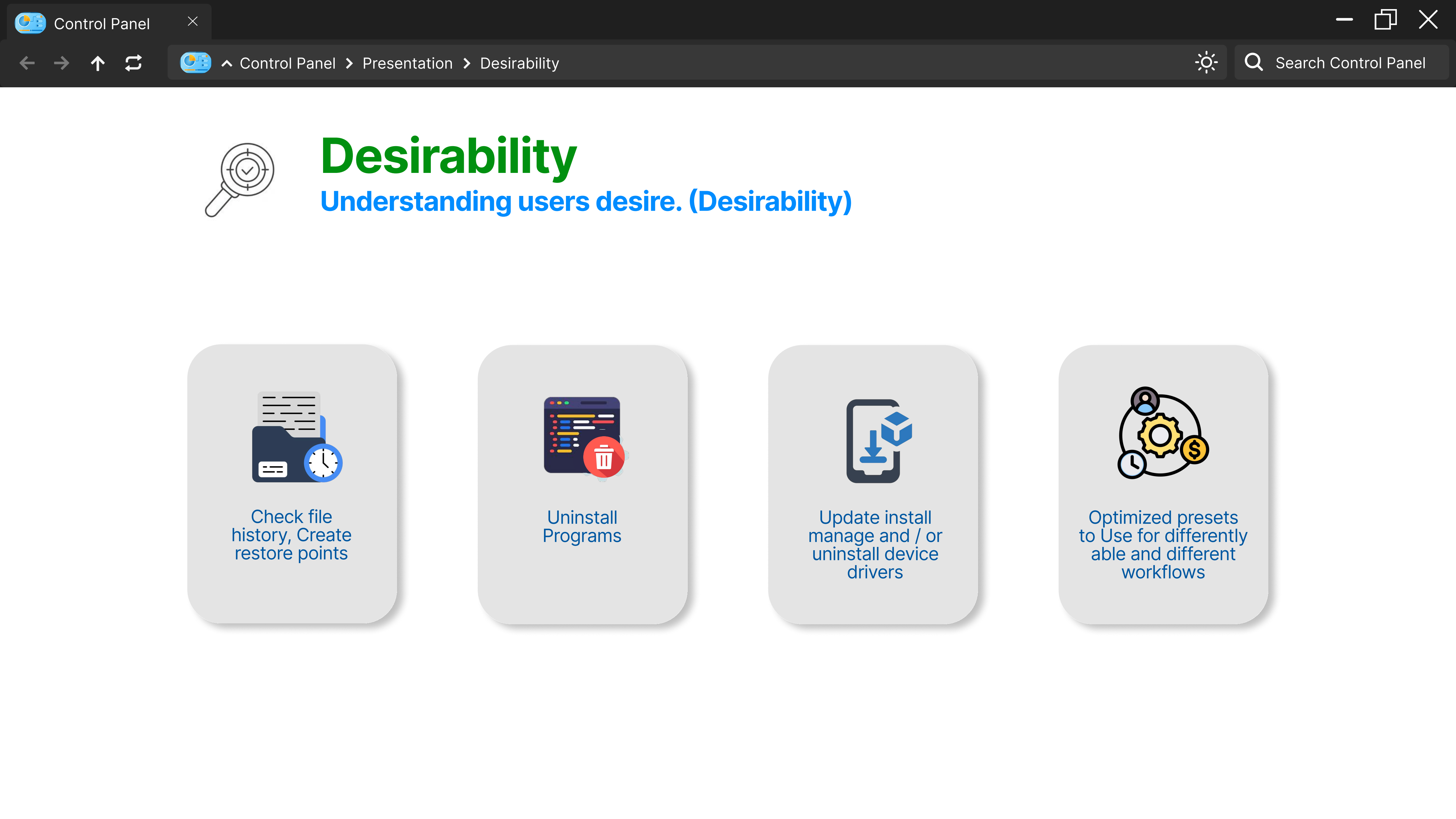
Program to change
core system
settings without
restrictions/
simplification



Reset PC to
improve
performance

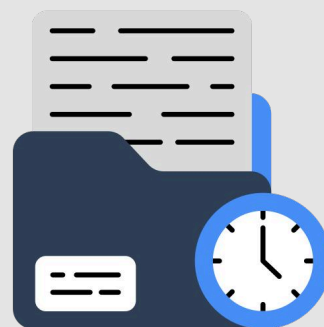


Check system
status & Resolve
issues

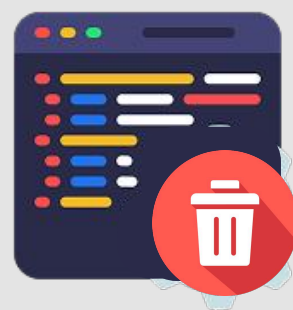


Desirability

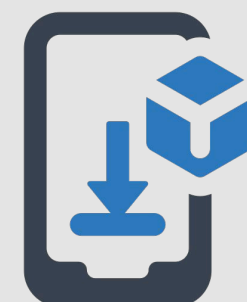
Understanding users desire. (Desirability)



Check file history, Create restore points



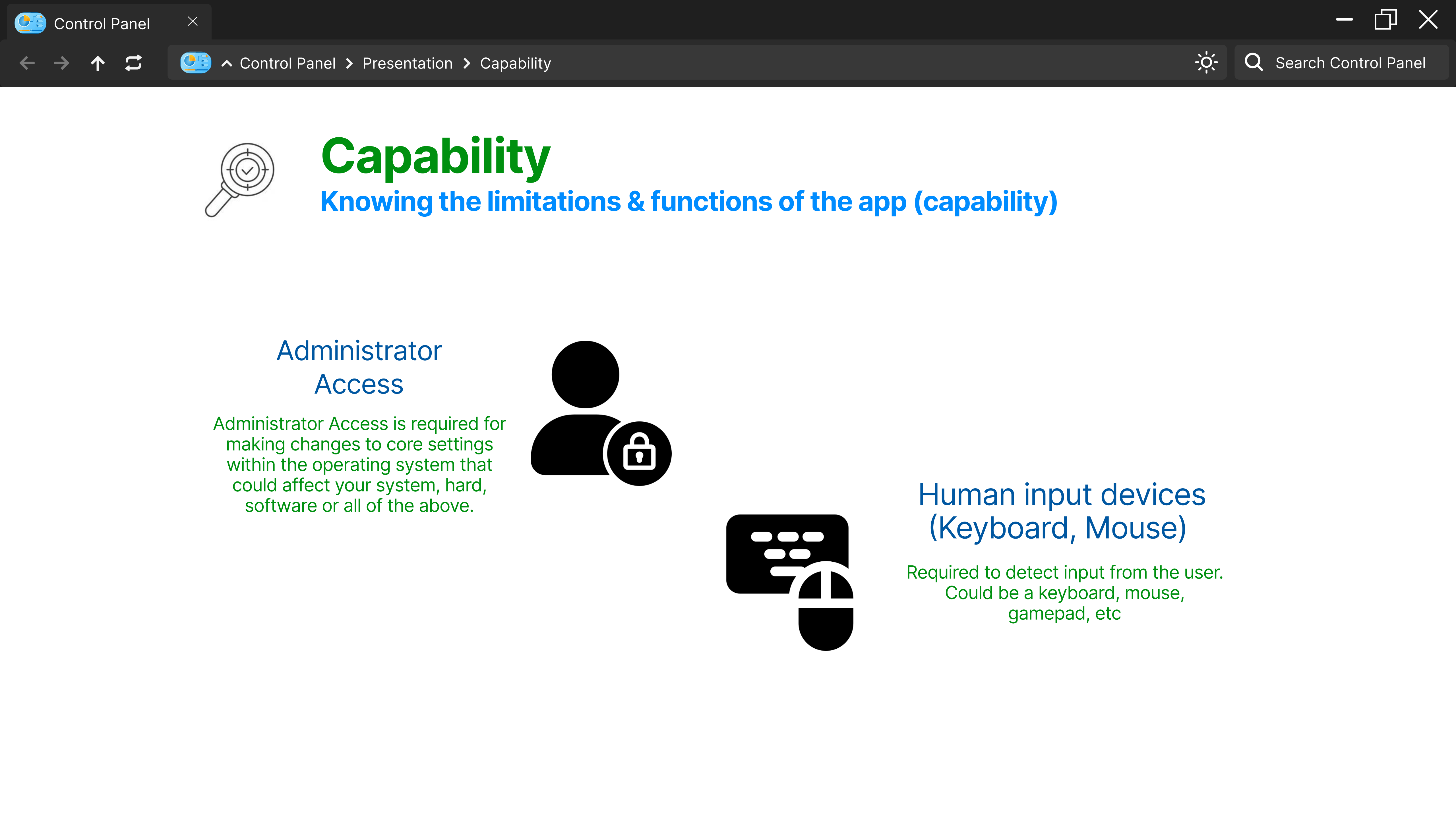
Uninstall Programs



Update install manage and / or uninstall device drivers



Optimized presets to Use for differently able and different workflows



Capability

Knowing the limitations & functions of the app (capability)

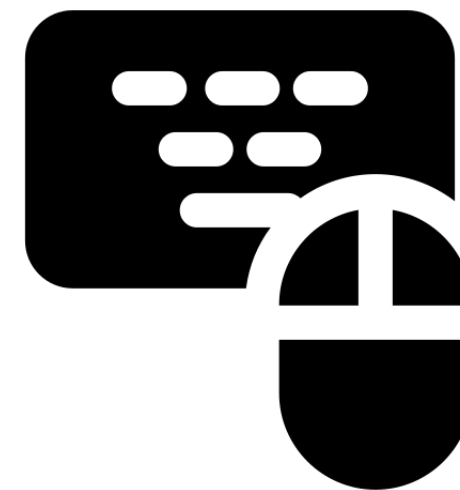
Administrator Access

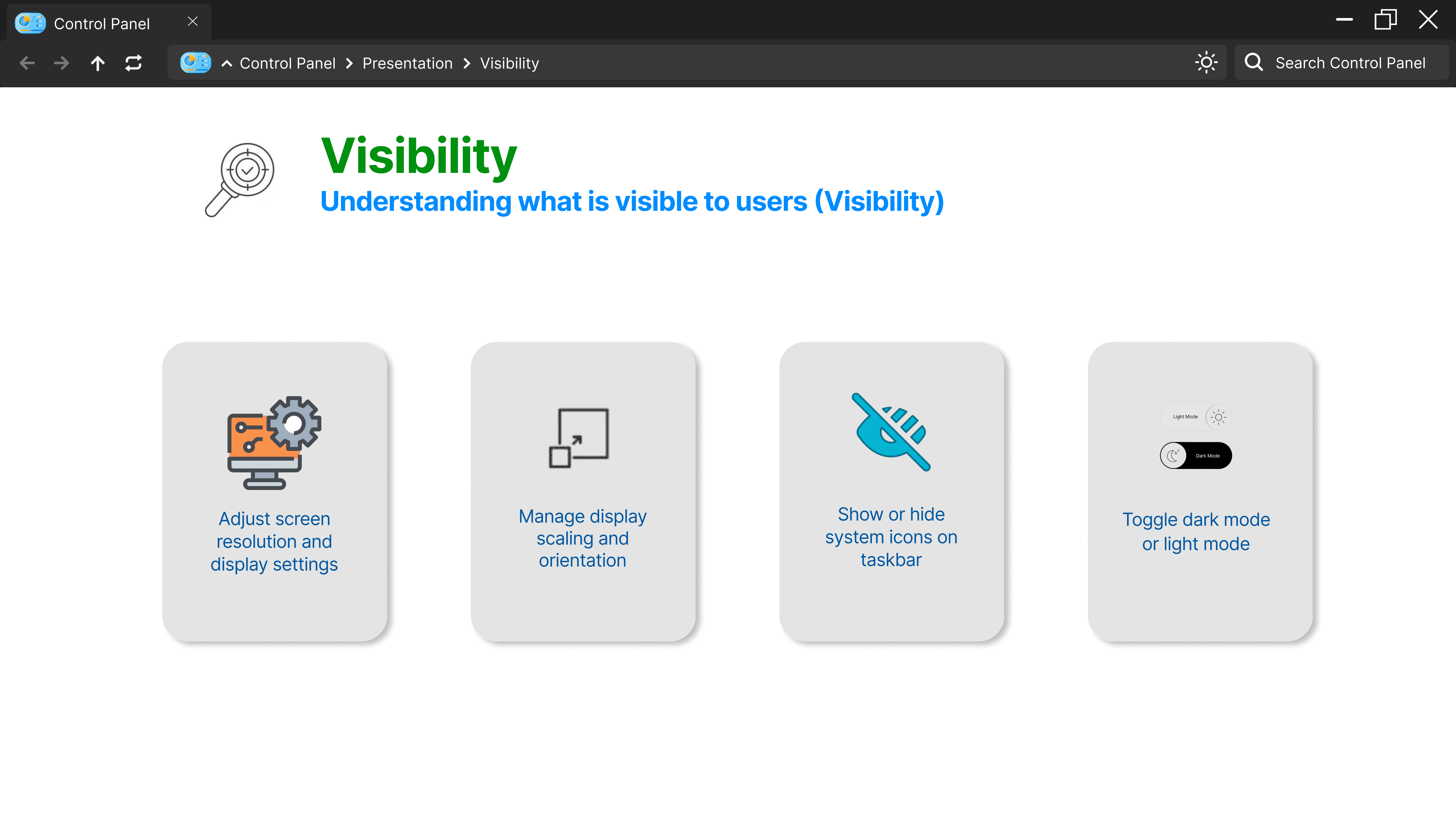
Administrator Access is required for making changes to core settings within the operating system that could affect your system, hard, software or all of the above.



Human input devices (Keyboard, Mouse)

Required to detect input from the user. Could be a keyboard, mouse, gamepad, etc



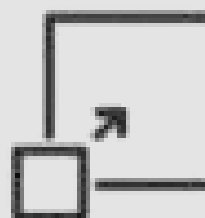


Visibility

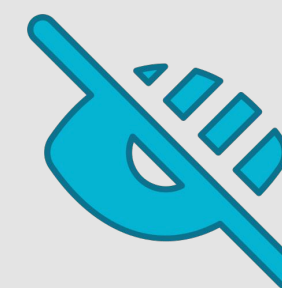
Understanding what is visible to users (Visibility)



Adjust screen resolution and display settings



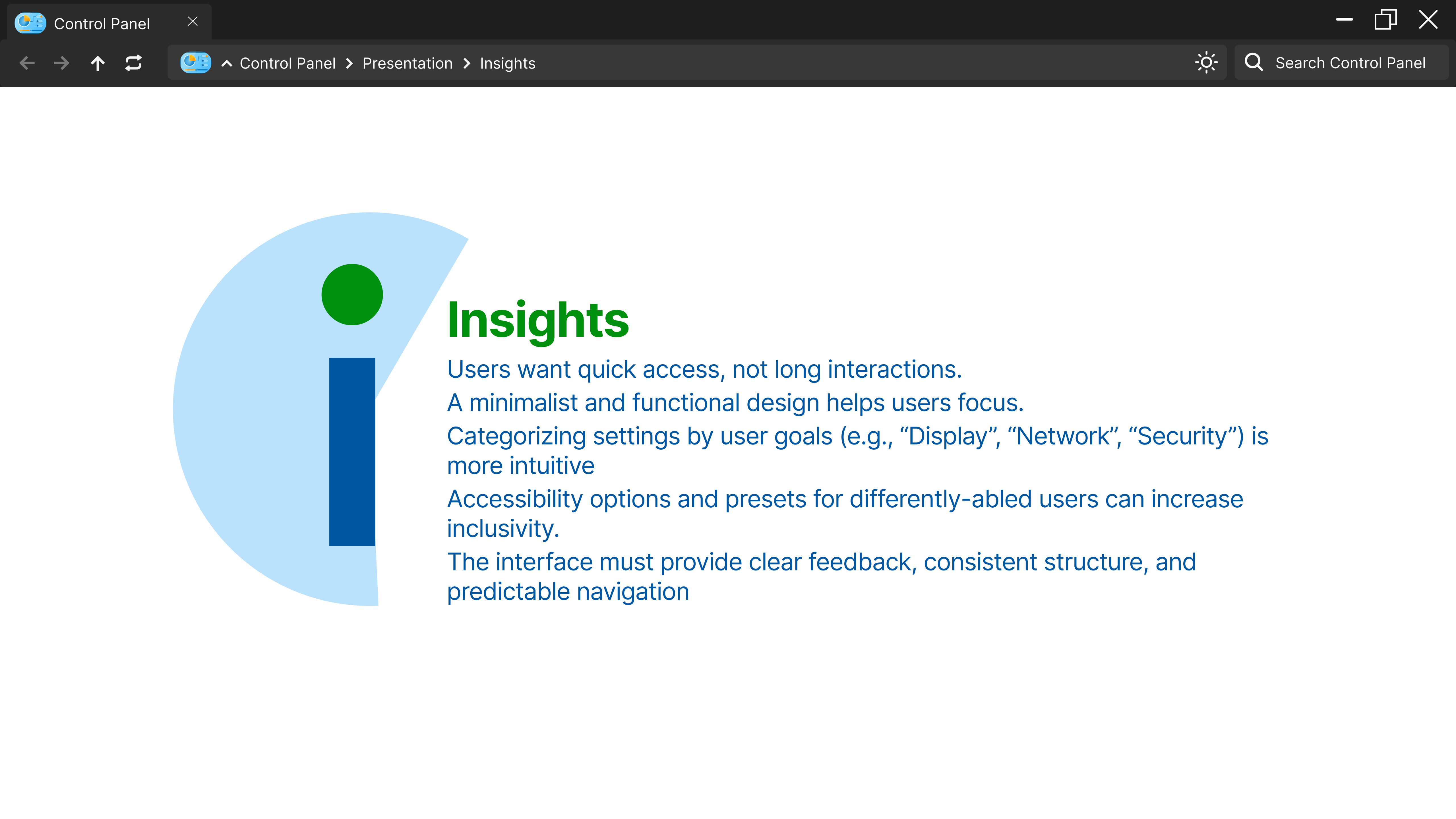
Manage display scaling and orientation



Show or hide system icons on taskbar



Toggle dark mode or light mode



Insights

- Users want quick access, not long interactions.
- A minimalist and functional design helps users focus.
- Categorizing settings by user goals (e.g., “Display”, “Network”, “Security”) is more intuitive
- Accessibility options and presets for differently-abled users can increase inclusivity.
- The interface must provide clear feedback, consistent structure, and predictable navigation